crimes against Israeli civilians as well as its responsibility for the outbreak of the war.

The executions of four Jews carried out by Amédy Coulibaly at the Porte de Vincennes kosher store in Paris on 9 January 2015 has further underlined the grim reality of the present. Once again the killer was a Muslim jihadist with ties to al-Qaida and/or the Islamic State organization. As with predecessors like Mohammed Merah and Mehdi Nemmouche, he had deliberately selected a Jewish target.

Not surprisingly, the growing presence of such murderous jihadi elements has greatly accelerated the current sense of eroding confidence of Jews in their future whether in France, Belgium, Great Britain, the Netherlands, or other European countries. This is particularly true for Jews living in heeavily Muslim-populated area where their situation has been precarious for some time. even before the events of this past year, they had little reason to believe that the toxic concentration of social evils in the *banlieues* (crime, drugs, rape, gang terror, family breakdown, or unemployment) would either decrease or cease to be projected against themselves as the move convenient scapegoats in any future crisis. It has become a truism for Jews in Europe living in any area largely populated by Muslims today, that to be seen with a *yarmulka* in public is to invite harassment, physical aggression, curses, and insults simply for being Jewish.[16] This has been the case for at least a decade, not only in Paris, but also in Amsterdam, Malmö, Copenhagen, Berlin, Brussels, Antwerp, Manchester, and London.

Such is the sombre truth concerning contemporary Europe and 21st-century antisemitism. During the recent years it was partly hidden from view since prejudice against Jews in the West was not felt in spheres like housing, education, and employment. There was relatively little discrimination in the economy, culture, the media, or politics. On the contrary, Diaspora Jews in the West (especially in the United States, Britain, and France) felt empowered—not least by the unprecedented levels of political sovereignty, civic freedom, scientific, technological, and military prowess manifested in the State of Israel. However, these successes have come at a price. the "new" antisemitism has lashed out in different ways at "Jewish power" and influence, all-too-often perceived though the lens of classical conspiracy theories poisoned by envy and resentment. The "Palestinian Question" has become the principal vector for expressing such resentment and hostility. It has adopted the deceptive mask of a "liberation struggle" for human rights, dignity, and social justice while stigmatizing Israel as an "apartheid state" practicing "genocide" against Palestinians. Hence the wars of hamas, Hezbollah, and Islamic Jihad against the Jewish State have enjoyed the seductive

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